3 Project Charter and Scope

3.1 Business case and project authority

HarbourCart (fictional) will be the prospective client for the project in question. In this instance, the Customer Operations Director is the sponsor, who retains control over the approval of the scope of the project, budget, acceptance criteria, and material changes.

3.2 SMART objectives and acceptance

ID	Proposed objective / measurable acceptance test
O1	An accuracy level of 85% is mandatory for the FAQ test that consists of 100 questionsFully sponsored and approved.
O2	Within the load test using 50 simultaneous users, the response time must not be more than 3 seconds for the test.
O3	In the case of 40 predefined escalation cases, 95% must be able to be routed.
O4	Once the pilot approves it, there should not be any unresolved security issue.

3.3 Scope, deliverables and exclusions

IN SCOPE	OUT OF SCOPE
Website chat widget, approved FAQ knowledge base, retrieval workflow and escalation button.	Automated refunds, payments, order amendments or access to customer account records.
Conversation design, security testing, pilot, training guide, acceptance report.	24/7 live-human staffing, multilingual support and mobile-app integration.

Deliverables include: D1: an approved charter and requirements; D2: FAQs and their answer rules; D3: a prototype chatbot; D4: a website handover process; D5: verification documents; and D6: pilot handover document. The dependencies include the approved content, access to the website, availability of hosting services, and comments from the sponsor. The planning assumption includes 12 weeks from 2 November 2026 to 24 January 2027 and indicates that the minimum provisional funding requirement is AUD 75,900 (AUD 70,900 estimated labour plus AUD 5,000 risk contingency), excluding as-yet unestimated hosting, API, software-licensing and support costs. Pilot implementation should take place in a designated test environment, where all inquiries will be made using artificial data until privacy and security evaluations are complete.

3.4 Stakeholders and governance

STAKEHOLDER	INTEREST / RESPONSIBILITY	ENGAGEMENT
Operations Director (sponsor)	Approves baseline, funding and acceptance	Fortnightly decision review

Support manager and agents	Own FAQ content, escalation rules and pilot feedback	Weekly workshop and testing
IT/security lead	Reviews integration, access and risk controls	At design and release gates
Customers	Need fast, understandable and safe answers	Pilot feedback and accessibility checks
Project team	Plans, builds, documents and reports progress	Twice-weekly Jira review